2. Rigid Constitution The Swiss Constitution is rigid in nature. It contains a special procedure for its amendment. It provides for two types of revision (amendment) i.e., total revision and partial revision:

(i) A total revision of the constitution may be proposed by the people or by either of the two chambers of the Federal Assembly or may be decreed by the Federal Assembly. If the initiative emanates from the people or if the two chambers are unable to agree, then the people will decide on whether a total revision should be carried out. If the people vote for a total revision, then new elections are held to both the chambers.

(ii) A partial revision of the constitution may be requested by the people or may be decreed by the Federal Assembly. The partial revision must respect the principle of cohesion of subject matter. Further, the popular initiative for partial revision must also respect the principle of consistency of form.

The totally revised or the partially revised constitution comes into force when it is approved by the people and the cantons.

Table 95.5 Swiss Constitution at a Glance (as Amended till now).

Title Number	Title Heading	Articles covered
I	General Provisions	1 to 6
II	Fundamental Rights, Citizenship and social Goals Chapter 1 – Fundamental Rights Chapter 2 – Citizenship and Political Rights Chapter 3 – Social Goals	7 to 41
III	Confederation, Cantons and Communes Chapter 1 – Relations between the Confederation and the Cantons Chapter 2 – Powers Chapter 3 – Financial System	42 to 135
IV	The People and the Cantons Chapter 1 – General Provisions Chapter 2 – Initiative and Referendum	136 to 142
V	Federal Authorities	143 to 191c